



CELL PHONES

Sony Ericsson W800i Walkman

Specs: 262K Colour Screen, Tri-band, Bluetooth, Infrared, 2-mp Camera with Flash, GPRS, Stereo FM radio, Expandable Memory, 512 MB Memory Stick Duo

Our Verdict: The best cell phone we've seen in the year, the Sony Ericsson W800i is the first mobile phone to sport the Walkman branding. It weighs just 99 grams, but packs in some mean features! In terms of memory, the 512 MB Memory Stick Duo card is decent.

Frequent SMSers will love the joystick and the keypad on the W800i. The

Walkman branding is justified by a couple of unique features: the ability to use the device as just a music player when the phone is switched off, and the provision of a standard 3.5 mm jack on the headset, which lets you connect your own headphones—or even connect the device to a home theatre system.

Whether you're a music lover, a shutter-bug, or just want to make a style statement, this is a great cell phone to own!



Runner-Up: Sony Ericsson K750i

DIGITAL CAMERAS

Low-End

Canon PowerShot A400

Specs: 3.3 Megapixel CCD Sensor, Maximum Resolution 2048 x 1536, 2.2X Optical Zoom With Additional Digital Zoom, 1.5-inch LCD Display, Integrated Flash, SD Memory Support, USB 1.1, Video-Out, AA battery

Our Verdict: In this segment, a combination of over 3 mp with a 2X optical zoom lens would make for a good camera—and that's where the Canon PowerShot A400 stands.

Colour reproduction is remarkable. The camera is comfortable to use, and the menu navigation buttons are ideally placed and sized. Very rectangular in

shape with slightly curved edges, this camera has sound build quality; it also has an inbuilt lens cover.



At purchase, the camera relies only on 16 MB of SD memory, which obviously can't store too many snaps. A notable aspect of the A400 is its wait time of only two seconds between two shots, which is good!

Good performance, a decent feature set and sensible pricing makes the Canon PowerShot A400 stand tall in the competitive entry-level segment.

Runner-Up: HP PhotoSmart M307

Mid-Range

Sony CyberShot DSC-W5

Specs: 5.1 Megapixel CCD sensor, Maximum Resolution 2592 x 1944, 3X Optical Zoom With Additional Digital Zoom, 2.5-inch LCD Display, Integrated Flash, MS Pro Memory Support, USB 2.0, Video-Out, AA Battery

Our Verdict: We felt this camera could have done with a higher optical zoom rating than 6X, but the Sony stands tall with its excellent and unmatched picture reproduc-

tion capabilities. Featured on this camera is the Carl Zeiss lens—a lens that has partnered with Sony in its success. 32 MB of internal memory lets the camera hold a few snaps without an additional memory card, but that is definitely not an alternative. The camera's size, build quality and ergonomics make it an ideal choice for travel.



HP PhotoSmart 945

Specs: 5.3 Megapixel CCD Sensor, Maximum Resolution 2608 x 1952, 8X Optical Zoom With Additional Digital Zoom, 1.5-inch LCD Display, Integrated Flash, SD Memory Support, USB 2.0, Video-Out, AA battery

Our Verdict: Somewhat on the bulkier side, this camera houses a rather small LCD screen. The HP 945 looks and feels like an SLR; the huge lens zooms to 8X. This is one feature-rich camera; you can use the printer USB attachment to directly print the snaps on a compatible HP printer.

The 945 can only captures 60 second movie clips, and the resolution of this capture is unusually low, at 288 x 208. Excellent ergonomics and good performance puts the HP PhotoSmart 945 in the winners' category.



Runner-Up: Sony CyberShot DSC-S40